

Observation & Documentation

Mandatory Skills Training — BSIS Required

Duration: 4 Hours

Authority: BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b)



MODULE 1

Report Writing

BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Five Standards of a BSIS-Compliant Report

FACTUAL — Only what you personally saw, heard, or did. No speculation.

ACCURATE — Correct times, dates, names, descriptions. Verify before submitting.

COMPLETE — All relevant persons, actions, outcomes, and witnesses included.

CLEAR — Plain English, logical order, no undefined abbreviations.

TIMELY — Written as close to the incident as possible, ideally within 1 hour.

Report Integrity Rules

Write in first person: 'I observed...', 'I heard...', 'I did...'

Never speculate: 'Subject appeared nervous' ✓ | 'Subject was guilty' ✗

Correct errors by single line through, initials, date — never erase or white-out

Reports are legal documents — may be used in civil or criminal proceedings

Never alter a submitted report without supervisor authorization

Falsifying a report is a crime and grounds for BSIS revocation

Required Elements — Every Security Incident Report

Date, time, exact location of the incident (address, floor, area)

Description of events in chronological order — what happened first, second, third

Parties involved: full descriptions (sex, race, approximate age, height, weight, hair, clothing, distinctive marks)

Witnesses: names and contact information if available

Actions taken by the guard: verbal commands given, physical actions, calls made, persons notified

Evidence observed or secured: describe in detail, do not move unless necessary for safety

Outcome: subject detained, released, turned over to police, medical response, etc.

Your name, guard card number, and MACCESS INC. PPO #122729 on every report



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MODULE 2

English Language Documentation Requirements

BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b)

English-Language Documentation

All official BSIS reports must be written in English

If your primary language is not English, you are still required to document in English

Seek assistance from a bilingual supervisor if needed — do not omit information

Translation apps may be used to assist communication — document their use

Quotes from non-English speakers: document in English, note original language used

BSIS audit may review reports — non-English documentation may be rejected

Communicating with Non-English Speakers

Use simple, clear language — avoid jargon and complex commands

Non-verbal communication: slow gestures, pointing, written notes

Translation apps (Google Translate, etc.) — useful but imperfect, note their use

Never assume non-English speakers are suspicious or uncooperative

Seek a bilingual colleague or professional interpreter for critical communications

Document the method used and the best understanding of what was communicated



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MODULE 3

Observation & Patrol Techniques

BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Effective Patrol Strategies

Vary patrol route and timing — predictable patrols are easily exploited

Know the baseline: what is normal at your post so anomalies stand out

Use all senses: sight, sound, smell (smoke, gas, chemicals)

Document patrol rounds: log start/end time, route, and all observations

Key checkpoints: all access points, parking areas, critical assets, blind spots

Report anomalies immediately — propped doors, unfamiliar vehicles, broken locks

Observation Best Practices

Scan systematically — do not focus on a single point

Distance observation before approach — assess before committing

Look for the '6 Ps': People, Positions, Patterns, Problems, Property, Processes

Night observation: use peripheral vision, not direct stare

Use available technology: CCTV, monitors — document camera IDs and timestamps

If something feels wrong, trust your training — investigate and document



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MODULE 4

Asking Appropriate Questions

BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Open vs. Closed Questions

Open-ended: 'What brings you here today?' — encourages narrative, gathers more information

Closed: 'Were you here yesterday?' — confirms specific facts

Use open questions first, then closed to confirm details

Avoid leading questions: 'You were trying to steal, weren't you?' — inadmissible

Neutral framing: 'Can you help me understand what happened?' — non-accusatory

Document: record exact quotes in your report — 'He said: I was just looking around'

Legal Limits on Questioning

Security guards CANNOT compel anyone to answer questions

Refusal to answer is NOT reasonable suspicion for detention

Do not threaten consequences for refusing to answer

Miranda rights do NOT apply to private security — but coercive tactics create liability

Share information with law enforcement when acting in official capacity

All questioning of suspects should be documented in the incident report



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MODULE 5

Observing Suspects & Suspicious Activity

BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Suspect Description — Standard Format

Sex — Male, Female, Non-binary (as apparent)

Race/ethnicity — as observed, non-judgmentally

Approximate age

Height and weight (estimate if not known)

Hair: color, length, style

Eyes: color if observed

Clothing: colors, brands, distinctive items, footwear

Distinctive features: tattoos, scars, piercings, glasses

Direction of travel or last known location

What Counts as Suspicious Activity?

Photographing or mapping security equipment, cameras, or access points

Testing locked doors or probing entry points repeatedly

Loitering without apparent purpose near sensitive areas

Vehicles circling the property multiple times

Persons who do not belong and cannot explain their presence

Unattended bags or packages left in unusual locations

Individuals watching guard patrol patterns closely

Document behavior only — never document race as the reason for suspicion



Course Complete

Observation & Documentation

Proceed to the online assessment. A score of 100% is required to receive your BSIS Certificate of Completion per BPC §7583.6(b) | Title 16 CCR §643(b).